



Cougar Winter Open
January 31-February 1
Pullman, WA on the WSU Campus

Sanction # IE-26-1626

Held under the sanction of USA Swimming and Inland Empire Swimming, Inc. Sanction #

Use of audio or visual recording, including the use of a cell phone camera, is not allowed in changing areas, rest rooms, locker rooms or behind the starting blocks. Deck Changing is prohibited: changing into or out of swimsuits other than in the facility locker rooms, or other designated area designated by the host facility, is not appropriate, and is prohibited. Operation of a drone, or any other flying apparatus, is prohibited over the venue (pools, athlete/coach areas, spectator areas and open ceiling locker rooms) any time athletes, coaches, officials and/or spectators are present.

Liability: In granting this sanction it is understood and agreed that USA Swimming shall be free and held harmless from any liabilities or claims for damages arising by reason of injuries to anyone during the conduct of the event. It is further understood that Inland Empire Swimming, Inc., all meet officials, Washington State University, and Cougar Aquatics shall be free and held harmless from any liabilities or claims for damages arising by reason of injuries to anyone during the conduct of the event. Damage to the facility, when proved, will cause the offending swimmer, if unattached, or the offending swimmer's team, if attached, to be held accountable for repairs.

Location: Gibb Pool - Washington State University | P E Building, Washington State University, 1302 Cougar Way Pullman, WA 99163, USA
Gibb Pool is in the Physical Education Building located between Smith Gym and Bohler Complex on NE Colorado St.

Format: Timed finals meet format. Seeding based on gender and age.

Course: Indoor, 8 lane, 25 yard pool equipped with eight starting blocks, backstroke flags, anti-wave lane lines and electronic timing using the Colorado Timing System with a full 8 lane scoreboard. Separate 4 lane warm up/down pool. Starting blocks meet USA Swimming height requirements. Water depth is 6' + at the start end and 4' + at turn end. A large balcony area is available for spectators. The host will ensure the required course dimensions.



Rules: Current USA Swimming rules will govern. The policies and procedures of Inland Empire Swimming will also apply. The referees of the meet shall be the final authority for the conduct of the competition. Only swimmers, coaches, officials, and meet workers will be permitted in the deck area. The deck area is considered to be the entire deck of the pool. Any swimmer entered in the meet must be certified by a USA Swimming member-coach as being proficient in performing a racing start or must start each race from within the water. When unaccompanied by a member-coach, it is the responsibility of the swimmer or the swimmer's legal guardian to ensure compliance with this requirement. Coaches must be currently certified members of USA Swimming and must provide proof of current certification upon request by the Meet Referee or their designee. The use of audio or visual recording devices, including a cell phone, is not allowed in changing areas, restrooms, or locker rooms, or behind the starting blocks. Operation of a drone, or any other flying apparatus, is prohibited over the venue (pools, athlete/coach areas, spectator areas and open ceiling locker rooms) any time athletes, coaches, officials and/or spectators are present. Deck changing is prohibited. Medical supervision will be available to all athletes participating in the meet, and to spectators in attendance. Lifeguards with current Red Cross lifeguarding, first aid, and CPR/AED certification will be on duty throughout warm-ups and competition. AEDs are located on the pool decks of both pools in use at this event.

Restrictions: ONLY USA SWIMMING-CERTIFIED ATHLETES, COACHES, OFFICIALS, & DESIGNATED MEET VOLUNTEERS ARE PERMITTED ON DECK. The deck area is defined as the entire pool deck surrounding the pool and behind the starting blocks. All swimmers entered in the meet must be under the supervision of a USA Swimming member coach during warm-up, competition, and warm down. Photography is not allowed behind the blocks during the start of a race or relay exchange. All athletes entered in the competition must comply with current USA Swimming rules regarding swimwear. Shaving is not permitted anywhere in the facility. Tobacco products, alcoholic beverages, and glass containers are not allowed in the venue. Only Service Animals are permitted in the Swim Center facility.

Photography: Photographers and/or videographers may be present at this meet. **Parents or guardians of swimmers under the age of 18 who do not wish to have photos or videos of their athletes made are required to contact the Meet Director via email no later than Thursday night, January 29, 2026.** The livestream will be performed from the corner of the seating gallery at the turn end of the pool.

Eligibility: Open to 2026 registered USAS athletes. Registration numbers must be included with entries. Age on the first day of the meet determines the age group to enter. Each swimmer must swim in his/her respective age group. Athletes with a disability are welcome and are asked to provide advance notice of necessary accommodations.



Entries: Swimmers may enter a maximum of 5 individual events per day and 1 relay per day. Enter swimmer's best yard times. NT entries are allowed. Please include the Team Manager 'Meet Entry' report or the enclosed Entry Fee Tabulation summary. Entries must include current (2026) USA Swimming ID numbers.

Please email the following 4 attachments to Russ Whitaker at russ.whitaker@wsu.edu prior to January 25.

1. Zip entry file from Team Manger.
2. Print to File of team individual entries
3. Print to File of team relay entries
4. Print to File of meet fees due

Payment is due at the start of Session 1. Checks can be mailed to:
Cougar Aquatics
PO Box 811
Pullman, WA 99163

Checks can also be delivered to the meet director at the Clerk of Course table when checking in with coaching credentials.

Time Trials: Time trials may be offered on a limited basis. Time Trial swimmers must already be entered in swim meet in order to participate in Time Trials and pay a \$10.00 fee for each Time Trial entered. Time Trial swims will count towards the maximum swims allowed per day. Coaches requesting a Time Trial for a swimmer that is already entered into the maximum number of events, must scratch that swimmer from an already entered event that day. Meet entry fees for events that are scratched in order to participate in Time Trials will not be refunded. The Meet Referee has the final decision on how many heats of Time Trials will be offered. The Meet Referee may also combine strokes of the same distance within the same heat. Time Trial requests must come from team coaches. Payment must be made at the time of entry.

Entry Fees: \$35.00 per athlete. (\$15.00 goes to IES for meet surcharge).
\$6.00 Individual event charge
\$16.00 Relay charge

Deck Entries: Swimmers who have not pre-entered the maximum number of events as stated above may deck enter additional events (up to the corresponding daily limit) with payment of \$6 per event due upon approval. Deck entries will only be allowed in open lanes at the discretion of the Meet Referee. Deck entry swims are not eligible for any awards or team points. **No deck registration will be permitted**



Coaches: Coaches must be 2026 USA Swimming Coach Members. Proof of current certification must be produced upon request by the meet referee and at check in at the clerk of course.

Officials:	Meet Director	Priscilla Schmidt
	Meet Referee	Rick Edge
	Meet Announcer	Russ Whitaker
	Admin Official	Don Hougardy
	Head Starter:	Hans Schmidt
	Stroke & Turn:	Yi Gu, Paige Buehler, Marcos Donolo

Cougar Aquatics welcomes the help from visiting officials. The uniform is a white shirt over blue shorts, pants or skirt and white shoes for both days.

Scoring/Awards: Heat winners will receive a duck. There will be high point awards for 8 & under, 9-10, 11-12, 13-14, and the 15 & over age groups. There will be no individual ribbons or medals for event winners. Scoring for individual events will be on an 8-place basis as follows: 9-7-6-5-4-3-2-1. No awards for team high point or team placing.

Timing: Two timers per lane. Timing assignments will be completed upon receiving entries. Each team will be required to provide timers for their assigned slots.

Meet Format: Meet format will be SCY, pre-seeded, timed finals Open individual events

- Will be swum Fast to Slow
- ALL relays will be swum single gender
- The Dive Well will be available during the meet to warm up/warm down
- Coaches must supervise their athletes at all times during warm ups.

Spectators: Spectators are REQUIRED to sit in the Gibb Pool seating Gallery. Spectators may bring chairs and blankets to sit on. Spectators are also welcome to sit in the Smith Gymnasium, which is down the hall from the Gibb Pool Seating Gallery.



Miscellaneous:

- Any protests or questions concerning the outcome of an event should be directed to the Meet Referee only. The protest should come from the swimmer's coach.
- There will be 2 meet marshals on deck for the entirety of the meet after warmups.
- 12 & Under swimmers will have a bullpen. Swimmers are asked to report before their event so that we can keep the meet moving.
- 13 & Over swimmers are responsible for reporting to the correct lane for their event.
- The Meet Referee may schedule ten-minute breaks during the competition, at his discretion.
- The USA Swimming SWIMS database requires that ALL swimmer data be correct before any meet data (swimmer times) be loaded into the USA Swimming database. If you know of any swimmer data that is NOT correct in the meet database, please notify the meet referee as soon as possible. The appropriate changes will be made. The data will be sent to USA Swimming within 3 days of the competition. Thank you for your cooperation.

**Safe Sport:**

The Safe Sport program is USA Swimming's comprehensive abuse prevention program dedicated to reducing the risk of sexual, emotional and physical abuse to athletes. Components of the program include, but are not limited to, providing education and training, enforcing policies, rules and best practice guidelines, promoting healthy boundaries and mandated reporting of violations.

The Minor Athlete Abuse Prevention Policy ("MAAPP") prohibits applicable adults from having one-on-one interaction with minor athletes that is not within an observable and interruptible distance from another adult. All adults participating in or associated with this meet, acknowledge that they are subject to the provisions of the USA Swimming MAAPP, and that they understand that compliance with MAAPP is a condition of participation in the conduct of this competition.

Pursuant to USA Swimming Rules and Regulations and federal law, it is every member's responsibility to immediately (i.e., within 24 hours) report any incident of child abuse, including physical or sexual abuse, to law enforcement and the U.S. Center for SafeSport. Reporting must occur when an individual has firsthand knowledge of misconduct or where specific and credible information has been received from a victim or knowledgeable third party. A report to the U.S. Center for SafeSport may be made via telephone at 720-531-0340 or online at uscenterforsafesport.org/report-a-concern. Various state laws may also require reporting to law enforcement or to a designated child protection agency.

All athletes age 18 and older must complete Athlete Protection Training ("APT") to be a USA Swimming registered member in good standing. Any athlete who turns 18 on or before January 31, 2026, who has not completed APT by the first day of competition, will be prohibited from participating in the competition until such time as all membership requirements are completed.

Times achieved by an athlete who turns age 18 on or before January 31, 2026, who competes in this USA Swimming sanctioned event without completing this membership requirement, will NOT count for qualification or recognition. This includes participation as a member of a relay. The requirement to complete Athlete Protection Training is an annual requirement. USA Swimming



EVENT DESCRIPTION

Session 1

- 1 Mixed 8 & Under 100 IM
- 2 Mixed 9-12 200 IM
- 3 Mixed 8 & Under 25 Breaststroke
- 4 Mixed 9-12 100 Breaststroke
- 5 Girls 8 & Under 100 Medley Relay
- 6 Boys 8 & Under 100 Medley Relay
- 7 Girls 9-12 200 Medley Relay
- 8 Boys 9-12 200 Medley Relay
- 9 Mixed 8 & Under 25 Freestyle
- 10 Mixed 9 -12 100 Freestyle
- 11 Mixed 12 & Under 50 Butterfly
- 12 Mixed 8 & Under 25 Backstroke
- 13 Mixed 9 -12 100 Backstroke
- 14 Mixed 11-12 500 Freestyle *Positive Check in required*

Session 2

- 15 Mixed 13 & Over 200 IM
- 16 Mixed 13 & Over 100 Breaststroke
- 17 Girls 13 & Over 200 Medley Relay
- 18 Boys 13 & Over 200 Medley Relay
- 19 Mixed 13 & Over 100 Freestyle
- 20 Mixed 13 & Over 200 Butterfly
- 21 Mixed 13 & Over 100 Backstroke
- 22 Mixed 13 & Over 500 Freestyle *Positive Check In Required*



Session 3

- 23 Mixed 9 – 12 100 IM
- 24 Mixed 12 & Under 50 Backstroke
- 25 Girls 8 & Under 100 Freestyle Relay
- 26 Boys 8 & Under 100 Freestyle Relay
- 27 Girls 9 – 12 200 Freestyle Relay
- 28 Boys 9-12 200 Freestyle Relay
- 29 Mixed 12 & Under 50 Freestyle
- 30 Mixed 8 & Under 25 Butterfly
- 31 Mixed 9 – 12 100 Butterfly
- 32 Mixed 12 & Under 50 Breaststroke
- 33 Mixed 8 & Under 100 Freestyle
- 34 Mixed 9 -12 200 Freestyle

Session 4

- 35 Mixed 13 & Over 400 IM
- 36 Mixed 13 & Over 200 Backstroke
- 37 Girls 13 & Over 200 Free Relay
- 38 Boys 13 & Over 200 Free Relay
- 39 Mixed 13 & Over 50 Freestyle
- 40 Mixed 13 & Over 100 Butterfly
- 41 Mixed 13 & Over 200 Breaststroke
- 42 Mixed 13 & Over 200 Freestyle

Positive Check In Required



Schedule:

Saturday	12:00pm	Warm Up Session #1
	12:30pm	Warm Up Session #2
	12:30pm	Officials Meeting
	1:00pm	Coaches Meeting
	1:15pm	Meet Starts

Session #2 warm ups will begin immediately following the conclusion of Session #1. There will be two sessions – each lasting 30 minutes. Session #2 events will start approximately 10 minutes after the warm up session is over.

Sunday	7:15am to 7:45am	Warm Up Session #1
	7:45am to 8:15am	Warm Up Session #2
	8:15am	Coaches Meeting (if needed)
	8:30am	Session #3 starts

Session #4 warm ups will begin immediately following the conclusion of Session #3. There will be two sessions – each lasting 30 minutes. Session #4 events will start approximately 10 minutes after the warm up session is over.